

Guidelines for PhD Thesis in Publication Format

Overview

The **PhD Thesis in Publication Format** is an alternative format thesis style where the work submitted for examination includes a core portfolio of articles written in a publication-formatted style, hereafter referred to as ‘the publications’, accompanied by narrative chapters to set the work in context. A thesis submitted in *Publication Format* may include both published and unpublished material, but does not require any of the material to have been published. However, it is strongly encouraged to publish research during the PhD enrolment. This thesis format recognises the importance of timely research dissemination for research impact, career progression and developing a research profile, and supporting open research principles. This thesis format provides an alternative format for those doctoral researchers who seek to gain experience in writing to produce peer-reviewed publications during their PhD enrolment, and reduces barriers to publishing research as they are not required to rewrite or reformat their published or publication-ready work. It is not an approach that will necessarily suit all doctoral researchers, projects, disciplines, or supervisors, as it places additional demands on the doctoral researcher and supervisory panel to plan, prepare, and potentially submit material for publication.

Undertaking a **PhD Thesis in Publication Format** requires the support of the supervision panel, normally from the point of confirmation of enrolment, as it may require a distinct structure to the research design. However, doctoral researchers can change thesis format at any time up to their submission for examination. If the thesis topic or research plan changes significantly at any point during enrolment, the thesis format should also be evaluated to ensure it remains appropriate. An alternative thesis format is a monograph, please see the **Guidelines for PhD Thesis in Monograph Format**.

The most important consideration when selecting a PhD thesis format is to decide which is most appropriate to the research topic and the specific programme of research required; all thesis formats are examined to the same standard. It is emphasised that a monograph thesis format does not preclude doctoral researchers from publishing their PhD research either during or following their enrolment or examination.

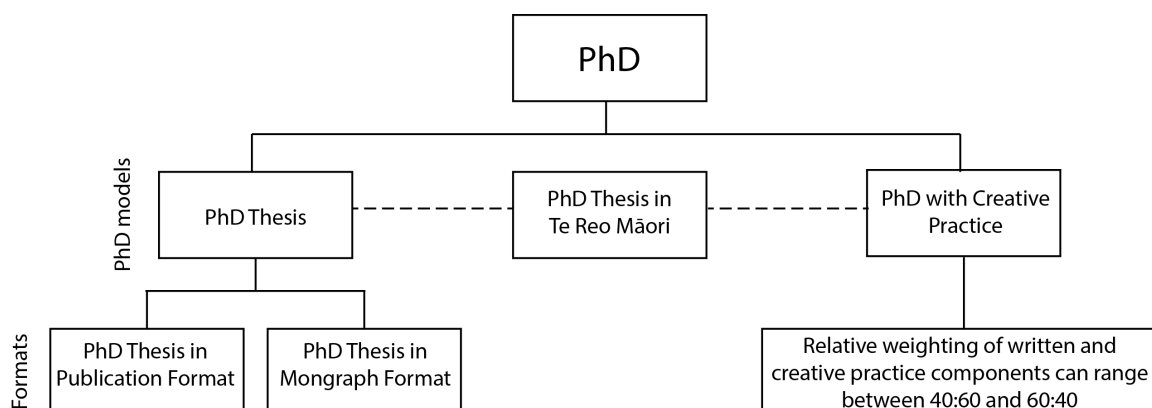


Figure 1: Summary of PhD models and formats available at the University of Waikato

Key Points

- There is no requirement for any part of the thesis to have been published at the time of submission.
- Publications must be accompanied by narrative chapters (i.e. introduction and synthesis/conclusion) to set the work in context.
- The exact number of publications included is not prescribed at a University level, but generally three or more would be expected to provide a doctoral-level contribution to knowledge or practice.
- Publications may include those written as journal articles, book chapters, conference papers, and potentially non-traditional research outputs, as long as they contain original research.
- The thesis format can be changed, for example from publication format to monograph, at any time. The final thesis format need only be declared formally at the point of submission.
- An alternative thesis format is the **PhD Thesis in Monograph Format**
- Co-authorship forms are required for each research publication included in the thesis.
- All material is examinable, regardless of the publication status.

1. Requirements

The **PhD Thesis in Publication Format** requires a core portfolio of articles written in a publication format, hereafter referred to as 'the publications', accompanied by narrative chapters to set the work in context.

The exact number of publications included is not prescribed at a University level and included may vary due to disciplinary expectations, the significance or contribution of the published work, or typical length of publications in the field or for the specific publication outlets. Generally, three or more publications would be expected to have provided a sufficient original research contribution for doctoral level study.

The publications included must be interconnected and linked to the specified PhD research project. That is, they cannot originate from a range of unrelated projects. The thesis, inclusive of both the publications and narrative chapters, must stand together as one coherent body of work advancing knowledge or practice on a specific topic. The narrative chapters are crucial in contextualising the body of work, introducing research questions and methods adopted, drawing meaningful connections between the publications, and synthesising the collective contribution to advancing knowledge or practice.

Importantly, the collective body of work should reflect the equivalent quantity, quality and originality of research and analysis expected of a candidate submitting a thesis in monograph format. The Chief Supervisor should provide appropriate guidance regarding disciplinary norms.

The publications, and the underpinning research, must have been undertaken during the period of enrolment in the PhD. Work published or prepared prior to the period of enrolment is not eligible to be submitted for examination within a **PhD Thesis in Publication Format** at the University of Waikato.

The Higher Research Degree regulations apply in full regardless of thesis format or model.

2. Status of publications

The articles in publication format do not need to have been published at the time of submission as the timescales of review and publication are largely outside the control of the doctoral researcher and should not negatively impact on submission, and all articles will be fully examinable as part of the examination process.

To be clear, the status of publications included in a **PhD Thesis in Publication Format** may be ready for submission; submitted; under review; accepted or published.

Please note that these are the minimum University requirements to submit as a **PhD Thesis in Publication Format**. Divisions/Faculty, or individual supervision panels, reserve the right to set higher requirements for submission via this format, such as requiring a specific publication status, reflecting disciplinary norms. Please consult with your Chief Supervisor regarding the requirements in your research area.

3. Eligible publication types

The publication outlet is not prescribed at the University level for submitted or published articles included in a **PhD Thesis in Publication Format**, as the thesis is fully examinable in its entirety and independent of publication status. However, doctoral researchers should be writing for peer-reviewed outlets and are encouraged to target those that are international and highly ranked in their discipline for publication. The quality of the journal should be demonstrable through their being competitive with a rigorous peer review process, the credibility they hold within the field, their impact factor and/or their inclusion in citation indexes.

- Academic journal articles presenting original research and following typical structural conventions. Review articles should contain an element of new and original research and contribute new knowledge, insight or recommendations for practice to the field.
- Book chapters. If a candidate has produced a book in entirety, submission in a monograph format may be more appropriate.
- Conference papers. In some disciplines, extended conference papers are competitive, undergo peer-review, and are published in conference proceedings. Short format conference abstracts will not usually be of sufficient depth to be included.
- Systematic reviews are eligible to be included, and may be included in the place of, or alongside, a standard literature review.
- Non-traditional publication types, such as policy papers or technical reports, may be eligible to be included but guidance should be sought from the supervision panel or Associate Dean Postgraduate Research. They should demonstrate original research and contribute new knowledge, insight or recommendations for practice to the discipline.
- Creative works are not eligible for this thesis format. Doctoral researchers who intend to produce creative works should see the **Guidelines for a PhD with a Creative Practice Component**, which is a distinct thesis model.

4. Narrative chapters

It is important to note that this is not a PhD by Publication (i.e. solely a portfolio of published work) and that the inclusion of narrative chapters is vital to producing an integrated and coherent PhD thesis. The submitted thesis must include the following chapters:

- An introduction outlining the overarching research question, hypothesis or aim, and providing the contextual framework for the contained publication-format studies
- A concluding discussion or synthesis chapter that (a) summarises the key outcomes and advances in knowledge or practice, (b) highlights the overall contribution of the publications, as a collective body of work, and critically evaluates the initial research question or hypothesis, and (c) identifies opportunities for future work.
- Separate literature review and methods chapters may also need to be included, especially if these matters are not dealt with at length in the research publication chapters. Please consult with your supervision panel for guidance on whether including either or both of these would be appropriate.

The Introduction chapter should contain an outline of the structure of the thesis, indicating clearly the current status of constituent publications (published, accepted, in revision following reviewers' comments, under review, submitted, ready for submission). Alternatively, this information may also be included in bridging paragraphs between each publication, which help to connect the individual works and can be used to signal the publication status and provide a citation for the work, if appropriate.

Publications included in a **PhD Thesis in Publication Format** that are submitted or published may include additional material (i.e. material not included in the published version) when presented in the thesis, such as to update or refine information, include further detail than permitted in the original publication due to word limits or to link with other sections of the thesis. These revisions should be clearly signalled in either the introduction or linking/bridging passages between publications where the work is referenced.

5. Formatting

The thesis should be presented in a consistent format, citation style, and typeface, unless including the publisher formatted version of a published article (see section 8).

Formatting requirements are not defined at a University level but should consider:

- Clear, easily readable font (e.g., 11 point Arial or Times New Roman)
- Sufficient line spacing to aid readability (e.g. 1.5 line space)
- Continuous page numbering throughout, accounted for if a publisher formatted article is included

Supplementary information associated with each publication should be included together at the end of the thesis and appropriately cross-referenced.

References associated with the citations contained in each publication should usually be included together in a single bibliography at the end of the thesis. However, published articles may retain their individual reference lists if included as the publisher formatted publication (see section 8).

Figures and tables contained in each publication should usually be numbered consecutively and cross-referenced as a single List of Figures in the front matter. However, published articles may retain their individual figure/table numbering if included as the publisher formatted publication (see section 8).

When including an article submitted or under review, it is recommended that tables and figures are included at the appropriate point at which they would appear in the final publication, rather than together at the end of the manuscript. This improves the readability of the document for the examiner.

6. Contributions and authorship

Co-authorship of publications with PhD supervisors and other collaborators is acceptable but the doctoral researcher should have contributed the greater proportion of work on all of the publications.

The doctoral researcher should normally be the lead author on all publications included within the thesis. Note, exceptions to this can be considered in those disciplines or journals where authors are expected to be listed alphabetically, or where publications have been jointly first-authored and the doctoral researcher's contributions are clearly outlined.

The **PhD Thesis in Publication Format** must include, as an appendix, a Co-Authorship Form for each research publication included, regardless of publication status. This form should outline the contributions of all the named co-authors, and estimate the percentage of their contribution. Doctoral researchers are encouraged to express author contributions using an appropriate convention for their discipline; for example, the CRediT taxonomy (<https://credit.niso.org>).

7. Examination

Examiners should be made aware that they are being invited to examine a **PhD Thesis in Publication Format** when they are asked to examine, so that they can make an informed decision. It is recommended that the examiners be made aware of the publication status (ready for submission, submitted, in review, accepted, published) at invitation stage, even though this information should be included in the thesis itself.

This document and further information about examining this thesis format will also be included in the Guidance for Examiners provided by SGR. The inclusion of published material does not alter the University's examination processes. Examiners are required to examine the thesis as a whole body of work and as it appears in front of them. They are at liberty to disagree with the findings or research design in a published article and to request revisions to published work, within the context of the thesis submitted in *Publication Format*.

For publications ready for submission or in review at the time of submission, doctoral researchers are encouraged to incorporate constructive feedback received during examination into the final published article.

8. Published versions and copyright

The final thesis will be made available open access (unless embargoed) in the University of Waikato's Research Repository, Research Commons, in alignment with open research principles.

Published works can be included in the thesis exactly as written. However, the copyright policies of the journal must be followed.

It is recommended that published works be included as the accepted and unformatted manuscript, not the publisher-formatted version. However, some publishers do permit PDF reproduction of the paper for inclusion in a thesis, and this is permitted. It is the responsibility of the doctoral researcher to gain permission to reproduce the work in the thesis and include a statement that such permission has been granted. The University Library can provide guidance.

Similarly, it is the responsibility of the doctoral researcher to ensure that any third-party copyright obligations to reproduce material contained in the thesis have been met.

Illustrative structure template

1. Title Page*
2. Abstract**
3. Acknowledgements (optional)
4. Table of Contents
5. Introduction and overview of the thesis
6. Literature Review^
7. Methods^
8. Core publications, written in publication-format with short linking/bridging passages to connect the publications if needed
9. Synthesis and conclusions
10. References not otherwise already included in the research publications*
11. Appendices: Any research appendices plus copies of the Co-Authorship Form for each publication.

* the date that appears on the title page should be the year in which the completed thesis is submitted.

** the abstract should be a succinct summary (no more than 350 words) of the overall aim, method(s), main finding(s) and conclusion of your research, considering all publications as a collective body of work

^these components may not be required as separate chapters if adequately covered within the publications

*published articles may retain their reference lists if included as the formatted publication.